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REQUEST FOR INDUSTRY-SPECIFIC SEARS FOR PROPOSED DATA CENTRE AT 3 BROOKHOLLOW AVENUE, NORWEST

1 INTRODUCTION

This scoping letter has been prepared on behalf of Greensquare Data Centres (GSDC) (the proponent) in relation to the site known as 3 Brookhollow Avenue, Norwest.

It has been prepared in support of a request for industry-specific Secretary's Environmental Assessment Requirements (SEARs) under the Rapid Assessment Framework (RAF). The proposal is considered to meet the criteria for industry-specific SEARs as the proposal is:

- wholly permissible;
- Would not meet threshold for designated development; and
- Would not comprise a concept development application.

The proposal involves the construction of a data centre development at 3 Brookhollow Avenue with a total power consumption of approximately 80 megawatts (MW).

The *State Environmental Planning Policy (Planning Systems) 2021* (Planning Systems SEPP) prescribes that development of Data Centres with a total power consumption of more than 15 megawatts, is a State Significant Development (SSD). The proposed development is considered to satisfy Schedule 1, Subclause 25 of the Planning Systems SEPP and therefore is considered to be SSD.

This report describes the site, its environs, and the proposal, and the relevant planning framework that applies to enable the issuance of SEARs, which will then guide the preparation of a formal EIS for development of the site. This report is submitted accompanied by Concept Architectural Plans which form **Attachment 1**.

The following sections provide an overview of the proposal to inform the Department's decision making for the issuance of industry-specific SEARs.

1.1 PROPONENT DETAILS

This report has been prepared by Patch Planning on behalf of the Proponent, whose details are provided in Table 1 below.

Table 1. Proponent Details	
Descriptor	Proponent Details
Proponent	GreenSquare DC c/- Patch Planning
Postal Address	70 George Street, Sydney 2000
Nominated Contacts	Ashleigh Smith, Associate Director

2 SITE OVERVIEW

2.1 STRATEGIC CONTEXT

The proposal aligns with the Greater Sydney Region Plan, Central City District Plan, the Hills Shire Local Strategic Planning Statement (LSPS) and the Norwest Precinct Plan, contributing to the region's growth and sustainability.

The proposed development will attract advanced manufacturing and innovation, creating jobs in the high-tech sector. The development repurposes underutilised land, aligning with planning priorities to retain and manage a highly desired land use.

Overall, the proposal supports regional development, job creation, and environmental sustainability in line with long-term planning goals and continues to align with the strategic vision of the wider precinct.

2.2 LOCAL CONTEXT

The site is known as 3 Brookhollow Avenue, Norwest (Lot 2021 DP 831173) and is in the Norwest locality, which forms part of the Hills Local Government Area (LGA). Development surrounding the site comprises of a mix of commercial, retail and residential land uses as described below:

- To the north of the site is Norwest Boulevard, commercial office buildings, an early learning centre, 'Castle Pines' retirement community and Castle Hill Country Club Golf Course;
- To the east of the site is Windsor Road, commercial office buildings, small pockets of residential development and industrial development;
- To the south of the site is Brookhollow Avenue, commercial developments, a hotel and medium density residential development; and
- To the west of the site is commercial development, including a shopping centre (Norwest Marketown), various retail offerings and the Norwest Metro Station.

The site is well serviced by public transport including bus and Metro. Norwest Metro Station provides connections to Tallawong in the northwest and Sydney CBD to the southeast. Bus stops along Norwest Boulevard provide connections through to Parramatta, Seven Hills and Rouse Hill.

As shown in the below mapping, the site is in proximity to Strangers Creek and Brookhollow Reserve, located at the site's southwestern border. Norwest Lake is located approximately 90m northwest of the site.

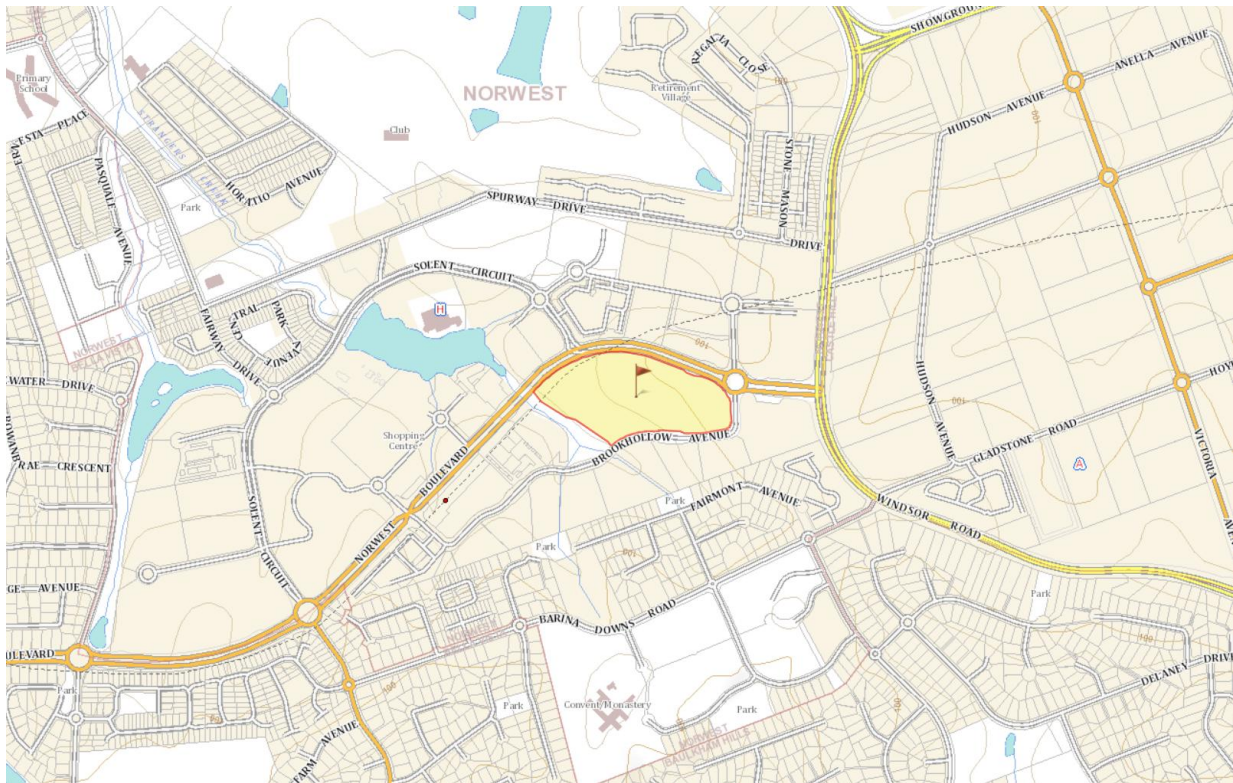


Figure 1. Site Context Map

Source: Six Maps

2.3 SITE DESCRIPTION

The subject site is legally described as Lot 2021 of Deposited Plan (DP) 831173. The site can be described as irregularly shaped and has a total land area of approximately 51,867sqm. A portion of the site currently comprises an existing 4MW data centre that was approved under D93/318, dated 21 June 1993.

The site is bound by Brookhollow Avenue to the south and east, Brookhollow Reserve and the Hills Corporate Centre to the west and Norwest Boulevard to the North. The primary frontage of the site is to Brookhollow Avenue, where vehicular access is provided.

Based on a review of topographical mapping, the site appears to fall from east to west from a maximum height of RL104 in the northeastern corner of the site to RL82m along the western portion of the site.

The site is located approximately 500m to the east of the Norwest Metro station, with the metro line running under the north / northwest boundary of the site.

The site is heavily vegetated, however, none of the vegetation is mapped on the biodiversity values mapping prepared under the *Biodiversity Conservation Act 2016* (BC Act).

Refer to aerials of the site at Figure 2 below.



Figure 2. The Site
Source: Metro Map, 2024 (modified by Patch)

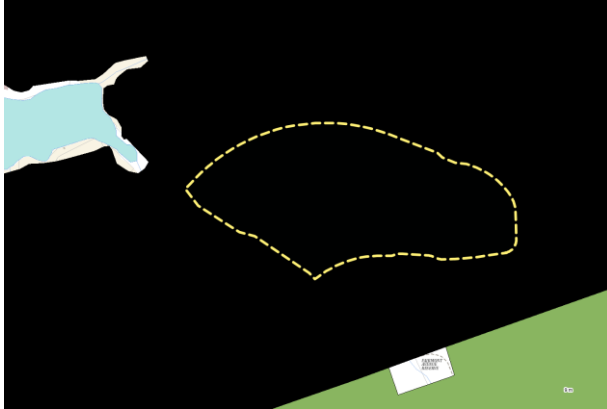
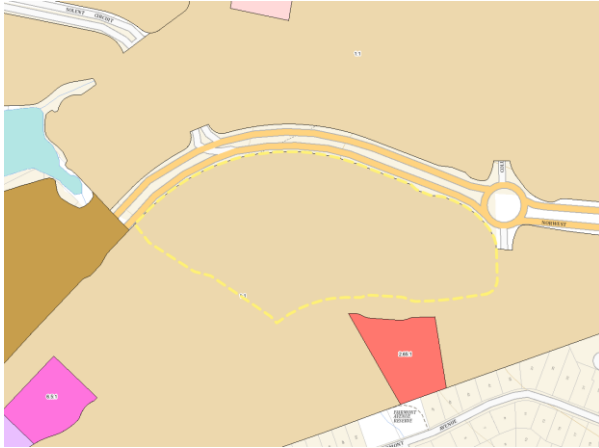
3 LOCAL PLANNING CONTEXT

The site is in Norwest Business Park forming part of The Hills Shire Council LGA and subject to the provisions of *The Hills Local Environmental Plan 2019* (THLEP 2019).

Key provisions applying to the site under the THLEP 2019 applicable to the site are outlined below.

Table 2. THLEP 2019 Summary	
Clause	Comment
Land Use Table	The subject site is zoned SP4 – Enterprise.  Data centres are a type of high technology industry, which are themselves a type of light industry. As such the proposed development is permissible with consent in the SP4 zone.

Table 2. THLEP 2019 Summary

Clause	Comment
4.3 Height of Building	The site is subject to a maximum building height of RL116.  The concept plans present a height of building of RL120, and a maximum height of 19m, exceeding the prescribed building RL under THLEP 2019. As aforementioned, it is acknowledged that these details are approximate and will be refined as design development progresses. Notwithstanding, any variation to the building height control will be addressed as part of the SSDA submission through a 4.6 variation statement.
4.4 Floor Space Ratio	The site has a maximum floor space ratio control of 1:1.  The indicative concept plan presents a combined GFA of 19,172sqm, equating to an FSR of 0.37:1, complying with cl. 4.4 of THLEP 2019.
5.10 Heritage Conservation	The site does not contain a heritage item nor is it within a Heritage Conservation Area (HCA).
5.21 Flood Planning	The site is not within the flood planning area or the probable maximum flood (PMF) area.

4 PROJECT DETAILS

4.1 PLANNING HISTORY

The site currently comprises an existing 4MW data centre that was approved under D93/318, dated 21 June 1993. In its current form, the site comprises a combined gross floor area of 8,955m² comprising of:

- Existing Office: 1,370m²
- Existing Data Centre: 7,615m²

In its current state, the facility is dilapidated, comprises outdated technologies, and does not respond to the evolving data storage demands of the market. As such, a development application has been prepared (with submission imminent) for assessment by the Hills Shire Council. Due to the estimated development cost of the proposal, it constitutes regionally significant development and the Regional Planning Panel will therefore be the determining authority.

In summary, the stage 1 works comprise the following:

- Alterations and additions to the existing 4MW data centre to provide for a 14.9MW data centre;
- Internal reconfiguration, optimisation and refurbishment of the existing facility to enable optimised performance and functionality;
- Installation of new external generators, water tanks and fuel tanks to support operations, with provision of up to 190 kilolitres (kL) of diesel in above ground generator belly tanks. The exact quantum of infrastructure proposed will be confirmed as design progresses;
- Façade rectification works and other minor external building changes which are currently outside of the scope of the current fire safety order;
- Installation of rooftop plant and equipment;
- Install an 11kV switching station within the southwestern portion of the site that will be owned by Ausgrid; and
- Subdivision of the site in preparation for the stage 2 development (which is intended to be on a separate parcel of land).

Additionally, the proposed development seeks consent to formalise the hours of operation to allow the site to operate 24 hours, 7 days a week.

4.2 SSD PROPOSAL

The proposed development, subject to this report, forms Stage 2 of the overall development of the Site. Stage 2 will seek development consent for the construction and operation of a data centre, with a total power consumption of approximately 80MW. The proposal will form part of a state-of-the-art data centre campus, equipped to cater for growing data storage needs within Australia and the emergence of artificial intelligence (AI).

Specifically, the proposal includes:

- Site preparation works including tree clearing;
- Bulk earthworks;
- Infrastructure comprising civil works and utilities;
- Construction of a three (3) storey data centre;
- Ancillary office, amenities and loading docks;

- On-site car parking;
- Diesel fuel storage for generators;
- Electrical substation and associated infrastructure; and
- Landscaping and offset tree planting.

The Concept Architectural Plans, prepared by Greenbox, are included within **Attachment 1**.

Table 3 below provides a summary of key development particulars of the development.

Table 3. Summary of Development Particulars			
Component	Stage 1	Stage 2	Total
Site Area	2.303 hectares	2.884 hectares	5.187 hectares
Power Consumption	14.9MW	80MW	94MW
Gross Floor Area	8,466sqm	10,706sqm	19,172sqm
Indicative Number of Generators	11 generators	66 generators	77 generators

5 CONCLUSION

This letter has been prepared on behalf of the Applicant and provides a description of the subject site and proposed data centre by Greensquare DC at 3 Brookhollow Avenue, Norwest.

It is considered that the letter provides sufficient information to enable the industry-specific SEARs for the project to be issued, however, should you require any further information please do not hesitate to contact me at any time on 0401 699 336 or via email at mstankovic@patchplanning.com.au.

Kind Regards,



Mason Stankovic
MANAGING DIRECTOR